

# Everyone wants the ocean. Start with a pond.

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Jun 29, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/4czAlZvuyYw> Source: full transcript

## Executive Summary

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New creators fail by chasing broad audiences too soon. The winning strategy is to dominate one narrow niche first, then "pond hop" to progressively larger audiences over time.

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## 🎯 Start With One Concentrated Niche 0:00

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- In the beginning, **nobody knows who you are** — that is the starting reality for every creator
  - Because of this anonymity, it is far easier to become known for one thing than for many things
- Creators who are now admired and widely followed almost always started with a much more concentrated, narrow audience (a "pond")
  - Their breadth today is the result of deliberate expansion over time, not where they began

## 🐸 Pond Hopping: Growing in Stages 0:00

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- Tim calls the growth strategy **"pond hopping"**
  - You start in one small, specific pond
  - Once you've established yourself there, you hop to the next pond — slightly bigger
  - You repeat this process, each time moving to a larger and larger pond
- This staged approach compounds recognition rather than diluting it by trying to appeal to everyone at once

## 🏆 The Fitness Analogy: Ronnie Coleman's Journey 0:23

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- Many people in fitness see the end result — athletes like **Chris Bumstead** or (from an earlier era) **Ronnie Coleman** — and want to be at that level immediately
  - What they don't see are the **years and phases** of progression that got those athletes to that point

- The same mistake applies to content creation: aspiring creators see successful, broad-reaching creators and try to replicate that scale from day one
  - They skip the foundational stages that made those creators successful in the first place

## **The Core Principle: Narrow Subject Matter Expertise 0:46**

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- The most effective way to get people to know who you are at the start is to **narrow in on one specific area of subject matter expertise**
  - Specificity creates recognizability — you become the go-to person for that one thing
  - Breadth comes later, after an audience base is already established

The ocean is the goal, but the pond is the path. Trying to own everything at once means owning nothing.